Homemade Acini di Pepe

Stiff semolina dough, rolled into thin ropes and cut into tiny beads.

MAKES **ENOUGH TO REPLACE 1 CUP DRY** · ACTIVE **45 TO 60 MIN** REST **30 MIN**

INGREDIENTS

180 g	semolina (about 1 cup)
85 g	warm water (about 1/3 cup)
	extra semolina, for dusting

METHOD

1. Stir the semolina and water together with a fork until shaggy, then knead on the counter **8 to 10 minutes** into a smooth, stiff dough. Add water a teaspoon at a time only if it won't come together; a firm, dry dough holds the tiny shape and doesn't smear when cut.
2. Wrap and rest **30 minutes** at room temperature so the semolina hydrates and the dough relaxes.
3. Cut off a small piece, keeping the rest wrapped so it doesn't dry out. Roll it under your palms into a rope about 1/8 inch thick.
4. Line up a few ropes and cut them crosswise into 1/8 inch pieces with a sharp knife or bench scraper. Toss right away in semolina so they don't stick, and spread on a dusted tray. Repeat with the rest of the dough.
5. Use fresh, or leave uncovered on the tray, stirring now and then, until hard all the way through, about **8 to 24 hours** depending on humidity.
6. Cook in boiling salted water or simmering soup: fresh beads take **3 to 5 minutes**; dried take a few minutes longer, so start tasting at **5 minutes**.

NOTES

Make ahead & storage

- Fresh: keeps **1 day** refrigerated in a semolina-dusted container. Or freeze on the tray, then bag; cook from frozen, adding about **1 minute**.
- Fully dried: keeps up to **1 month** airtight at room temperature.

Pairs with

- Italian Wedding Soup with Acini di Pepe. Stir fresh beads in for the last **5 minutes**.

Tips

- Hand-cut pieces are tiny cubes, not the smooth beads of store-bought. They cook and eat the same.

SALT, FAT & FIRE
GRAIN & NOODLE · HAND-ROLLED, BOIL

Written for personal kitchen use.